

JS8FastChat Instructional Guide Ver1.55

See “JS8FastChat Installation & First Run Guide” for install instructions

1 What this Guide Covers

This guide explains what each control in JS8FastChat does. It assumes the program is already installed and talking to JS8Call. If it is not, work through the JS8FastChat Installation & First Run Guide first — **nothing here will make sense until the two programs are connected.**

FastChat does not replace JS8Call. It sits beside it and puts the things that normally take a right-click and a menu onto single buttons. Most operators shrink the window and park it over the JS8Call waterfall so both are visible at once, which is what the picture below shows.

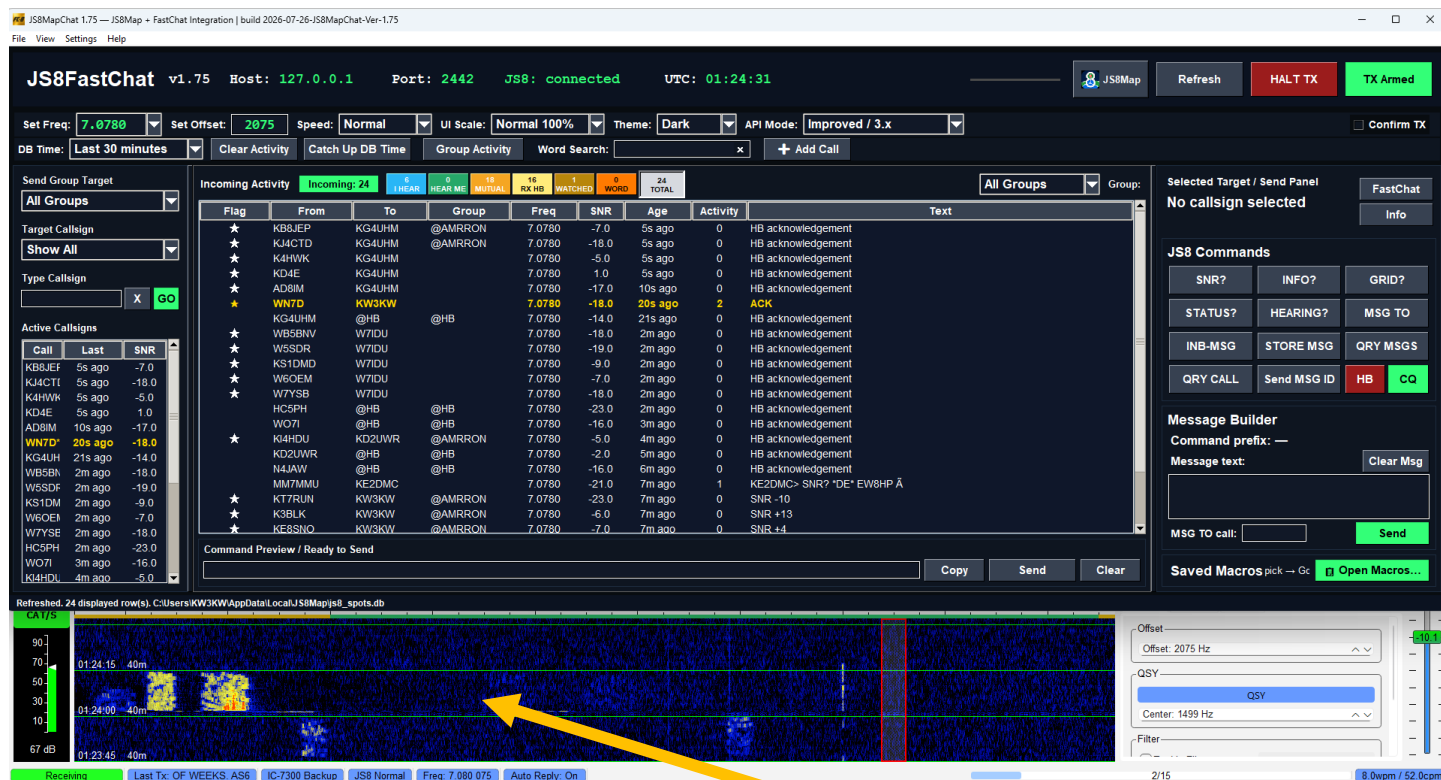


Figure 1 — JS8FastChat reduced in size so it sits over the JS8Call waterfall.

Note: Hover tooltips on every control in this application.

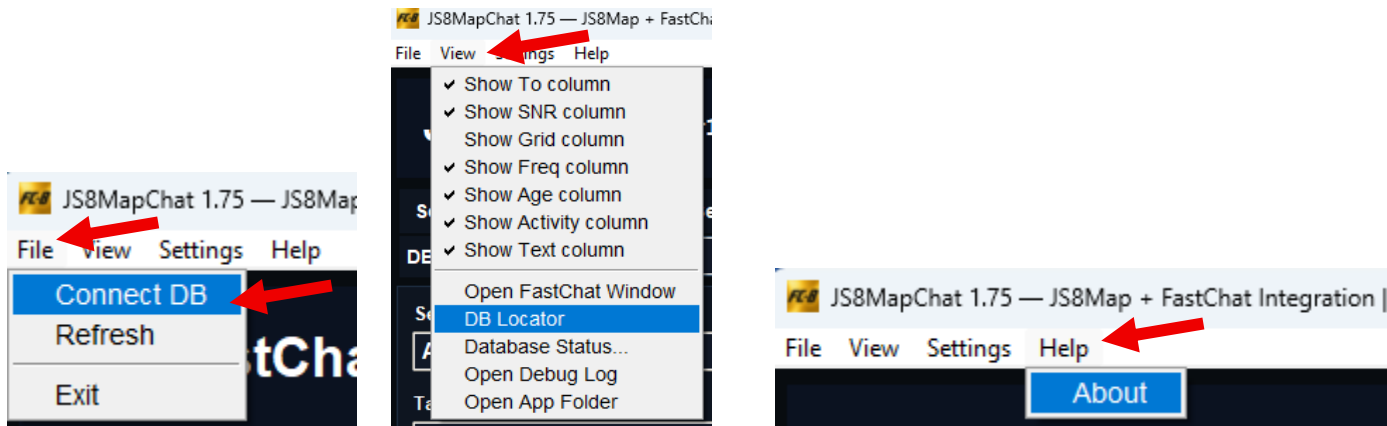
2 The Menus

Three menus sit above the header.

File — reconnects to the callsign database, refreshes the data FastChat has pulled from JS8Call, and closes the program. Closing FastChat does not close JS8Call.

View — turns each column of the activity list on or off, opens a FastChat window for the highlighted station, and holds the database tools — DB Locator, Database Status, the debug log, and the application folder.

Help — shows which version you are running.



Figures 2, 3 and 4 — The File, View and Help menus.

3 The Header

The header runs across the top of the window and carries the controls you reach for most often, along with the line that tells you whether JS8Call is actually connected.

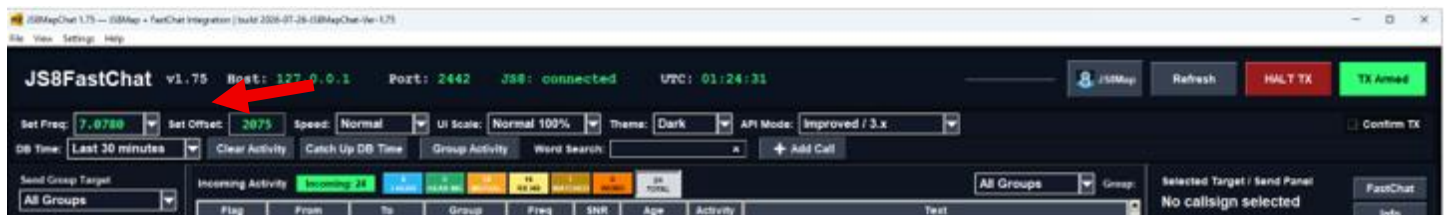


Figure 5 — The header, across the top of the window.

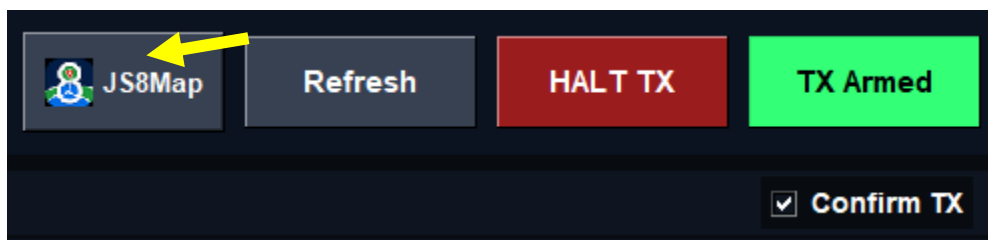


Figure 6 — The header buttons: JS8Map, Refresh, HALT TX, TX Armed, and the Confirm TX tick.

- JS8Map Button – Pulls the JS8Map forward for single click view and access.
- Refresh – Auto refreshes the system in between scheduled auto refresh – based on your settings
- HALT TX – for JS8Call Improved versions, the new API allows for FastChat to halt TX without having to go to the JS8 screen to perform this function.
- TX Armed – Green means the system is set to fire over to JS8Call
 - Checked Confirm TX – requires you to approve each command that is sent over to JS8
 - Unchecked Confirm TX – auto sends all commands to JS8Call as if you did it in JS8 itself

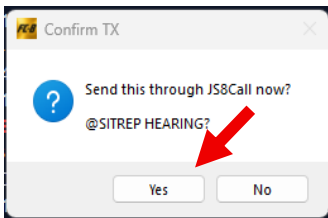


Figure 7 — Confirm TX. With the box ticked, every command waits for your approval before it reaches JS8Call.



Figure 8 — The status line: version, host, port, connection state and the UTC clock.

4 Filters and Dropdowns

The second row decides two things: what FastChat sends to JS8Call, and how much of the incoming traffic it shows you. These settings take effect immediately.

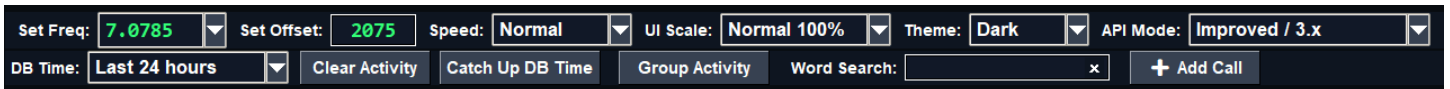
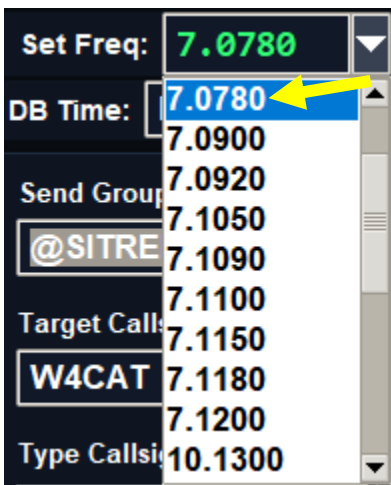
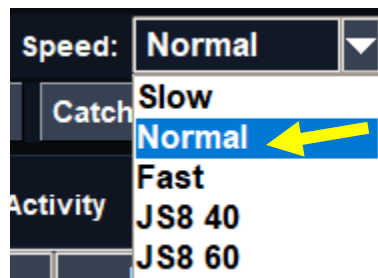
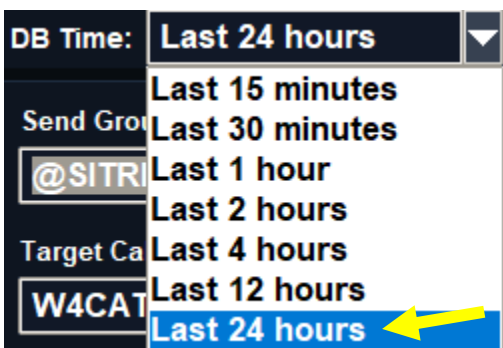


Figure 9 — The filter and dropdown row.



Figures 10 and 11 — Set Freq picks from the band list. Set Offset can be typed straight into the box.



Figures 12, 13 and 14 — DB Time, JS8Call speed, and the display theme.

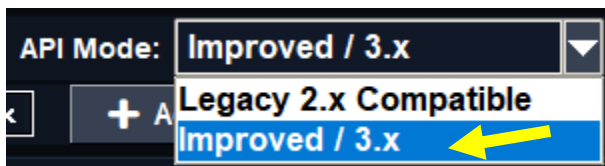


Figure 15 — API Mode. Legacy 2.x Compatible, or Improved 3.x.

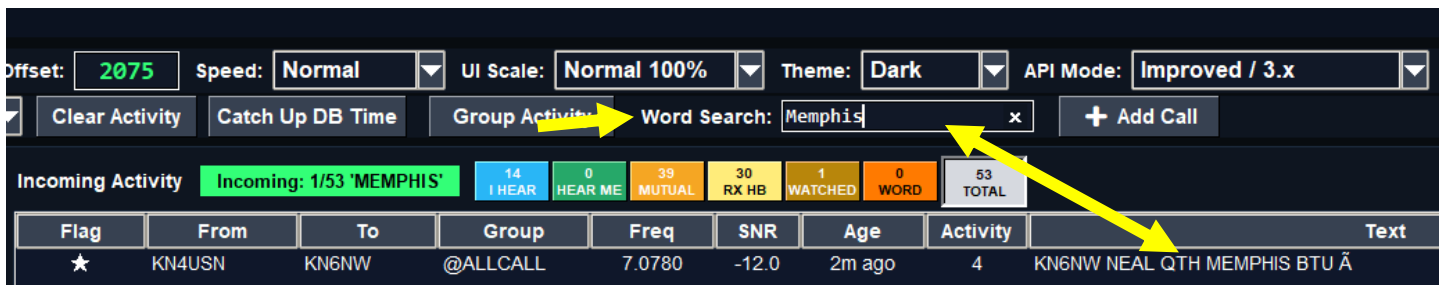


Figure 16 — Word Search.

Note: Word search only applies to current info in the main FastChat window. You can do a complete word search, to each individual callsign, under the History tab. See History section for more info.

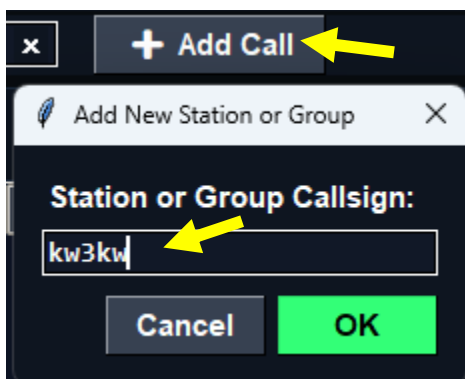


Figure 17 — Add Call. Adds a station or a group that JS8Call is not showing.



Figure 18 — The filter tiles. Each one narrows the Incoming Activity list; TOTAL puts it back.

Press each button to supply specific filter. To return to normal, click the TOTAL button

5 The Left Side of the Screen

The left column is where you choose who a command is aimed at, and it gives you a second, quieter view of who is active without disturbing the main activity list.

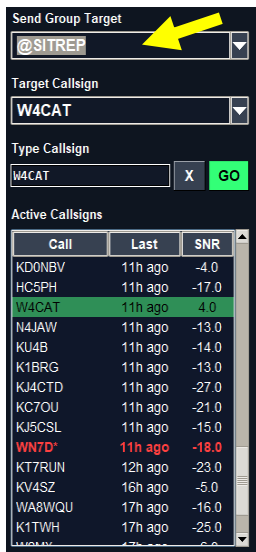


Figure 19 — The left side: send group, target callsign, type callsign, and the Active Callsigns list.

- Group Dropdown to SEND JS8 commands to a selected group
- Targeted Callsign – to send JS8 commands to a specific callsign
- Type Callsign – selects callsign on Current Activity screen – **X to clear the highlighted callsign on Current Activity screen**
- Active Callsigns header – Call, Last or SNR sort list for that box only. Second way to look at activity quickly without changing the main Incoming Activity screen

6 The Incoming Activity window

The middle of the window is the live activity list. Every decode JS8Call hands over appears here. This is the screen you watch, combining the three JS8 windows into one view. Fast sort capability built-in.

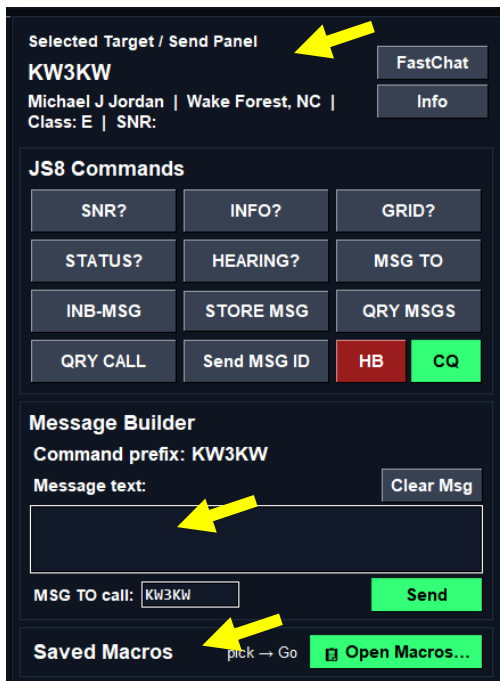


Figure 23 — The right side. Every JS8 command for the highlighted callsign, one click each.

JS8 Commands for HIGHLIGHTED Callsign.

- Secondary way to open the callsigns FastChat Window
- All key commands to auto send to JS8 with a single button click
 - a. HB Button
 - b. CQ Button
- Typing Box to send messages
- JS8 Macros for fast use commands
 - a. Select and hit the ENTER key to send
 - b. Select and hit GO to send

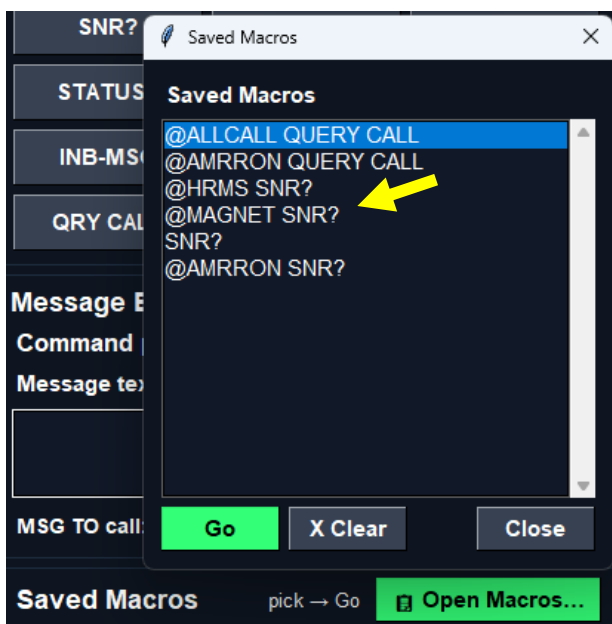


Figure 24 — Saved Macros.

8 The FastChat Popup Window

Main view to use in FastChat. To open, first highlight a callsign in the activity list. Next, double-click a station. The callsign you want to work with, gets its own window. This is where most operating actually happens, because everything to do with one operator is in one place.

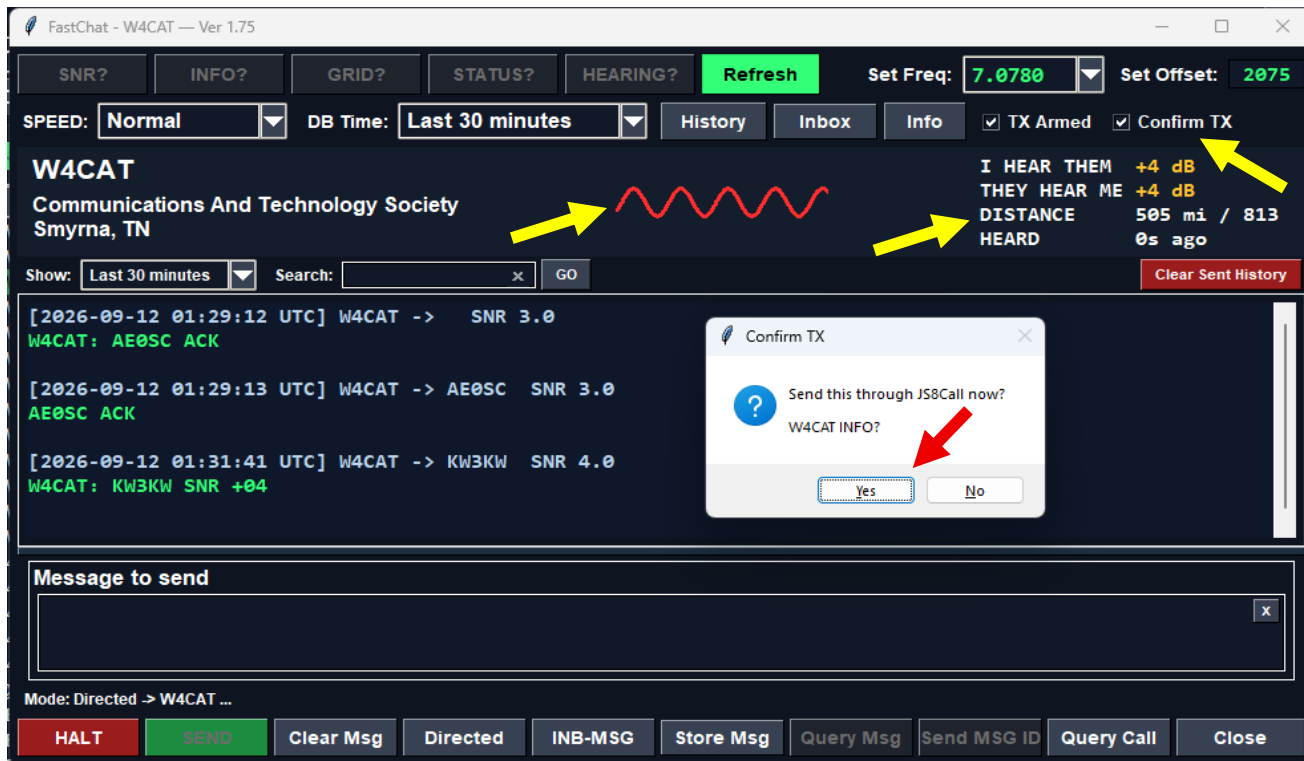


Figure 25 — A FastChat window, with Confirm TX waiting for approval.

- Many of the same key features on the main screen but for a specific callsign. This allows to a single click to use all the JS8 features without having to right-click and or open list of options to use.
- **Red sine wave** indicates rig TX in process and blocks and send functions until TX is completed.
- Allows for direct sending to JS8 or a confirmation popup for tighter TX control – Confirm TX
- Callsign operator name and information in one quick view
- SNR report for both ways – I Hear Them and They Hear Me
- Distance between you and them, Last Heard time
- Allows for key access to info
 - Inbox
 - Info (FCC Callsign DB Info)
 - History – shows their current activity for the session. Red font for history sessions.
 - **Other Traffic** – all activity for that operator and their contacts during the session. Allows you to see BOTH theirs and the RX callsigns activity in ONE view. Blue for other traffic sessions.

Flag	From	To	Group	Freq	SNR	Age	Activity	Text
★	KN4USN	KN6NW	@ALLCALL	7.0780	-6.0	11h ago	8	KN6NW YAESU 991A 22W DIPOLE IN ATTIC- YUR DOING GUD
★	NZ1ON	N0MTV	@SITREP	7.0780	-12.0	11h ago	4	ACK
★	W01F	KE7DFT	@PNWPRN	7.0780	-1.0	11h ago	3	KE7DFT SNR? Å
★	W4CAT	KW3KW	@SITREP	7.0780	4.0	11h ago	3	KW3KW INFO SEND "E? CMDS" FOR MORE INFO 2TERSE.COI
▶ WATCH	W4JBB	@SITREP	@SITREP	7.0780	-14.0	11m ago	2	@SITREP MSG F!104 100 ST[AL] GR[EM63EH] #ILIL Å

Figure 26 — Directed traffic highlighted in the activity list.

QSO History - KN4USN - Last 24 hours

KN4USN History

Show: Search:

[2026-09-12 01:49:43 UTC] KN4USN -> KN6NW SNR -13.0
KN6NW SNR -20 [RSNR:-20]

[2026-09-12 01:51:27 UTC] KN4USN -> KN6NW SNR -6.0
KN6NW SNR -21 [RSNR:-21]

Figure 27 — History for a single station.

Other Traffic - KN4USN - Last 24 hours

Traffic involving KN4USN (not directed to/from me)

Show: Search:

[2026-09-12 01:55:27 UTC] KN4USN -> KN6NW SNR -12.0
KN6NW YOU CPY?

[2026-09-12 01:57:27 UTC] KN4USN -> KN6NW SNR -12.0
KN6NW NEAL QTH MEMPHIS BTU

[2026-09-12 02:00:43 UTC] KN4USN -> KN6NW SNR -11.0
KN6NW RPT PLS

[2026-09-12 02:03:27 UTC] KN4USN -> KN6NW SNR -8.0
KN6NW -20DB- BETTER

[2026-09-12 02:05:58 UTC] KN4USN -> KN6NW SNR -7.0
KN6NW YUR RIG?

[2026-09-12 02:07:30 UTC] KN6NW -> KN4USN SNR -25.0

Figure 28 — Other Traffic: both sides of a conversation between two other stations.

9 JS8Map and JS8FastChat together

The two programs are linked in both directions, and this is the feature that makes JS8MapChat more than two tools that happen to share a folder.

- In JS8Map – select callsign dot and open up callsign popup
- Select the FastChat button and it opens the FastChat window for that callsign. Now use all the key features to make your experience a “Fast Chat” with your fellow operator.



Figures 29 and 30 — In JS8Map, click a station dot to open its popup, then click FastChat.

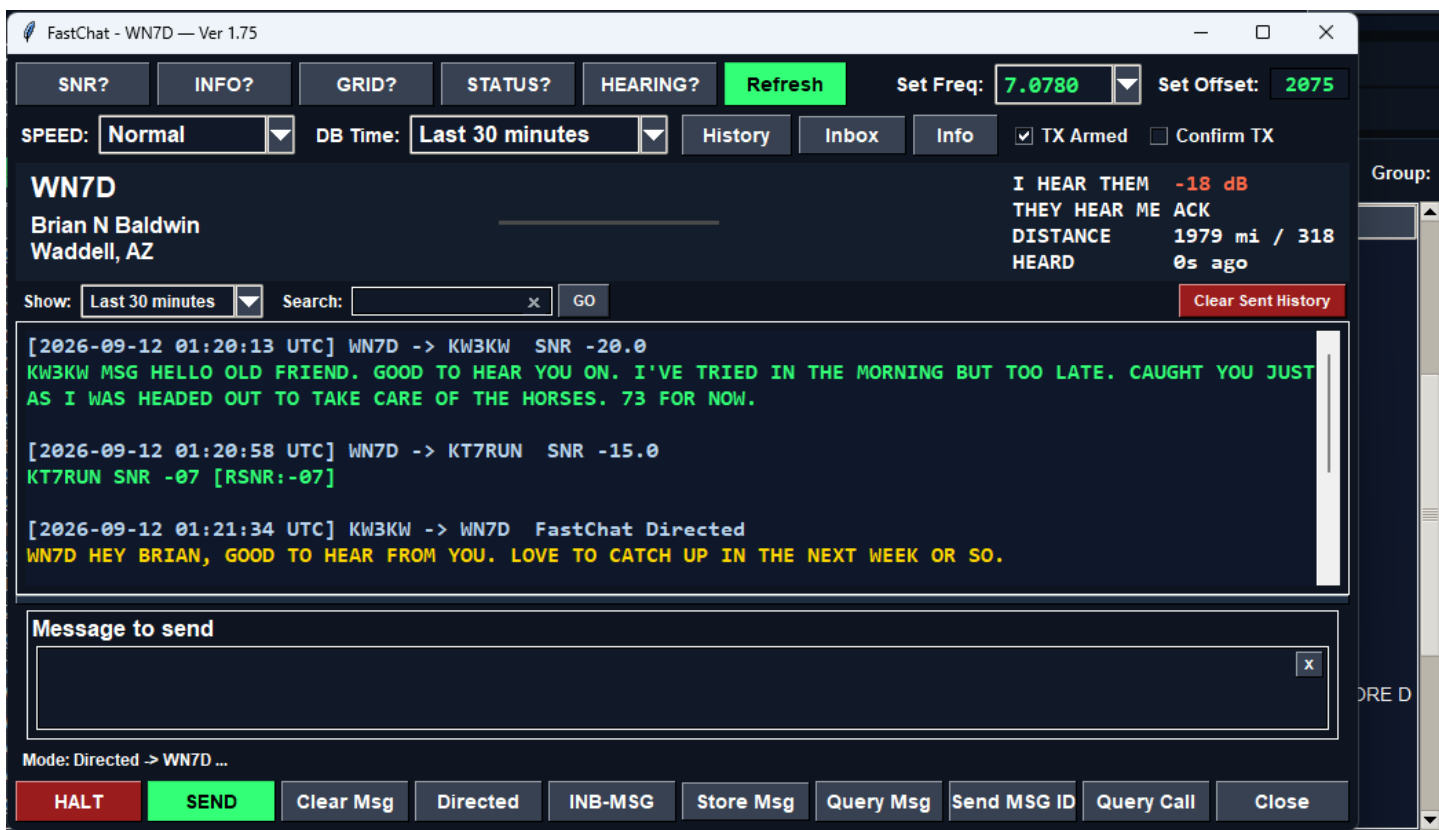


Figure 31 — The FastChat window that opens for that station.